

LT Credit: Access to Quality Transit

This credit applies to

- ▶ BD+C: New Construction (1-5 points)
- ▶ BD+C: Core and Shell (1-6 points)
- ▶ BD+C: Schools (1-4 points)
- ▶ BD+C: Data Centers (1-5 points)
- ▶ BD+C: Warehouses and Distribution Centers (1-5 points)
- ▶ BD+C: Hospitality (1-5 points)
- ▶ BD+C: Retail (1-5 points)
- ▶ BD+C: Healthcare (1-2 points)

INTENT

To encourage development in locations shown to have multimodal transportation choices or otherwise reduced motor vehicle use, thereby reducing greenhouse gas emissions, air pollution, and other environmental and public health harms associated with motor vehicle use.

REQUIREMENTS

NC, CS, DATA CENTERS, WAREHOUSES & DISTRIBUTION CENTERS, HOSPITALITY, RETAIL

Path 1. Access to Public Transit Service (1 to 5 points BD+C, except Core and Shell; 1 to 6 points Core and Shell)

Locate any *functional entry* of the project within a ¼-mile (400-meter) *walking distance* of existing or planned bus, *streetcar*, or *informal transit stops*, or within a ½-mile (800-meter) walking distance of existing or planned *bus rapid transit* stops, passenger rail stations (i.e. light, heavy, or commuter rail) or commuter ferry terminals. The transit service at those stops and stations in aggregate must meet the minimums listed in Table 1. Planned stops and stations may count if they are sited, funded, and under construction by the date of the certificate of occupancy and are complete within 24 months of that date.

Both weekday and weekend trip minimums must be met.

- ▶ For each qualifying transit route, only trips in one direction are counted towards the threshold.
- ▶ For weekend trips, only trips on the day with the higher number of trips are counted towards the threshold.
- ▶ If a qualifying transit route has multiple stops within the required walking distance, only trips from one stop are counted towards the threshold.
- ▶ Privately-run shuttles are only acceptable for Path 1 if the service is also made available to the public.

Table 1. Minimum daily public transit service

Weekday trips	Weekend trips	Points BD&C (except Core and Shell)	Points BD&C (Core and shell)
72	30	1	1
100	70	2	2
144	108	3	3
250	160	4	4
360	216	5	6

If *existing* transit service is temporarily rerouted outside the required distances for less than two years, the project may meet the requirements, provided the local transit agency has committed to restoring the routes with service at or above the prior level.

OR

Path 2. Access to Project-sponsored Transit Service

Commit to providing year-round transit service (vans, shuttles, buses) for regular occupants and visitors that meets the minimums listed in Table 2. Service must be guaranteed for at least 3 years from the project's certificate of occupancy.

Within the project boundary, provide at least one transit stop shelter at each transit stop within a ¼-mile (400-meter) walking distance from a functional entry of the project. A building lobby is allowed instead of shelter if the transit stop is visible from inside and located no greater than 200 feet (60 meters) walking distance from the transit stop.

- ▶ For each qualifying transit route, total trips (inbound and outbound) are counted towards the threshold.
- ▶ If a qualifying transit route has multiple stops within the required walking distance, only trips from one stop are counted towards the threshold.
- ▶ Only directly accessible trips within the specified distances are allowed. Trips available from connected transit facilities do not contribute to the minimum trips under Path 2.

Table 2. Minimum daily project-sponsored transit service

Total daily trips	Points
30	1
45	2

Provide a guaranteed ride home program for employees who have carpooled, taken transit, walked, or cycled to work but require alternative transportation home for emergencies or unscheduled overtime.

SCHOOLS

Option 1. Transit-Served Location (1–4 points)

Locate any *functional entry* of the project within a ¼-mile (400-meter) *walking distance* of existing or planned bus, *streetcar*, or *informal transit* stops, or within a ½-mile (800-meter) walking distance of existing or planned *bus rapid transit* stops, passenger rail stations, or commuter ferry terminals. The transit service at those stops and stations must meet the minimums listed in Tables 1 and 2. Planned stops and stations may count if they are sited, funded, and under construction by the date of the certificate of occupancy and are complete within 24 months of that date.

- ▶ For each qualifying transit route, only trips in one direction are counted towards the threshold.
- ▶ If a qualifying transit route has multiple stops within the required walking distance, only trips from one stop are counted towards the threshold.

Table 1. Minimum daily transit service

Weekday trips	Points
72	1

144	2
250	3
360	4

Projects served by two or more transit routes such that no one route provides more than 60% of the prescribed levels may earn one additional point, up to the maximum number of points.

If existing transit service is temporarily rerouted outside the required distances for less than two years, the project may meet the requirements, provided the local transit agency has committed to restoring the routes with service at or above the prior level.

OR

Option 2. Pedestrian Access (1-4 points)

Show that the project has an *attendance boundary* such that the specified percentages of dwelling units are within no more than a 3/4-mile (1200-meter) walking distance (for grades 8 and below, or ages 14 and below), and 1 1/2-mile (2400-meter) walking distance (for grades 9 and above or ages 15 and above) of a functional entry of a school building. Points are awarded according to Table 3.

Table 2. Points for dwelling units within walking distance

Percentage of dwelling units in attendance boundary	Points
50%	1
60%	2
70% or more	4

In addition, locate the project on a site that allows pedestrian access to the site from all residential areas in the attendance boundary.

HEALTHCARE

Locate any *functional entry* of the project within a 1/4-mile (400-meter) *walking distance* of existing or planned bus, *streetcar*, or *informal transit* stops, or within a 1/2-mile (800-meter) walking distance of existing or planned *bus rapid transit* stops, passenger rail stations or commuter ferry terminals. The transit service at those stops and stations in aggregate must meet the minimums listed in Tables 1 and 2. Planned stops and stations may count if they are sited, funded, and under construction by the date of the certificate of occupancy and are complete within 24 months of that date.

Both weekday and weekend trip minimums must be met.

- ▶ For each qualifying transit route, only trips in one direction are counted towards the threshold.
- ▶ If a qualifying transit route has multiple stops within the required walking distance, only trips from one stop are counted towards the threshold.

Table 1. Minimum daily transit service

Weekday trips	Weekend trips	Points
72	30	1
144	108	2

Projects served by two or more transit routes such that no one route provides more than 60% of the prescribed levels may earn one additional point, up to the maximum number of points.

If *existing* transit service is temporarily rerouted outside the required distances for less than two years, the project may meet the requirements, provided the local transit agency has committed to restoring the routes with service at or above the prior level.

GUIDANCE

Refer to the LEED v4 reference guide, with the following additions and modifications:

Behind the Intent

Beta Update

Updates to this credit recognize the challenges project teams face in meeting the pervasive limitations to weekend transit requirements. The weekend minimum thresholds are reduced and project teams are now allowed to count the weekend day with the higher number of trips rather than the weekend average. With newly added intermediate thresholds, projects (excluding Core and Shell) can now earn 2 and 4 points, as well as a 3-point threshold for Schools.

Path 2, Project-sponsored Transit Service has been added to recognize the benefits of developer- or employer-sponsored transit service toward reducing SOV trips and VMT impacts from the project, especially in areas where public transportation does not exist or does not provide high frequency service.

Step-by-Step Guidance

Follow steps in the LEED v4 reference guide, with the following modifications:

- ▶ Step 4. The number of transit vehicle trips on a weekend. If weekend counts are different, only count the weekend day with the highest number of trips.
- ▶ Disregard any mention of the “commuter rail or ferry only” pathway. This section has been removed from the rating system.
- ▶ For Path 2, follow the steps outlined below:

Step 1. Select private transit service provider

Identify and hire a private transit service capable of providing transportation between the project site and external destinations (e.g., residential areas, public transportation stations). Year-round service for regular occupants and visitors at the minimum service frequency stipulated in credit requirements must be guaranteed for at least 3 years from the project's certificate of occupancy.

Step 2. Plan private transit service

Using a site map, show the service route and regular stops. The route must include at least one transit stop with shelter within a ¼-mile walk distance from a functional entry of the project or a building lobby within 200 feet walking distance of the transit stop, as indicated in the credit requirements. Route should be designed to reduce driving trips to the project site; destinations may include residential areas and/or public transportation stations. Plan for operation with minimum service frequency indicated in the credit requirements.

Step 3. Plan rider facilities

If transit stop(s) are located more than 200 feet from building lobby, provide adequate transit shelter(s) for riders. For a building lobby within 200 feet of transit stops that will be used as a qualifying waiting area, ensure adequate space is available for waiting riders.

Step 4. Establish guaranteed ride home program

Design a qualifying program that provides a guaranteed ride home for employees who have taken transit, carpooled, walked, or bicycled to work but require alternative transportation home for emergencies or unscheduled overtime. The program may utilize taxi, ridehailing service, or company vehicles. A guaranteed ride home policy must be maintained that specifies the following, at a minimum:

- Employee eligibility
- Trip eligibility
- Maximum number of uses
- Responsibility for program administration
- Procedures for using the program, including any necessary forms for registration and/or reimbursement

Source: Adapted from “Guaranteed Ride Home: A Backup for Commuters Who Use Alternative Modes.” Victoria Transportation Policy Institute (VTPI). <https://vtpi.org/tdm/tdm18.htm>

Further Explanation

Example

- ▶ The example provided references commuter rail, light rail, and averaged weekend trips. These references are no longer applicable and should be disregarded.

Required Documentation

For Path 2. Project-sponsored transit service, the following documentation is required:

- ▶ Map showing planned route, including transit stop(s) on project site with distances from functional entries, and off-site destinations. Include a description of off-site destinations.
- ▶ Schedule of year-round service, including service frequency (total trips per day)
- ▶ Guaranteed ride home policy

Definitions

Refer to the LEED v4 reference guide for additional definitions.

- ▶ Replace all references to rail transit with the umbrella term, “passenger rail”. Replace all references to “rideshare” with the term “informal transit”.
- ▶ **passenger rail** a diversity of rail transit service including light, heavy, and commuter rail transit. Passenger rail systems are characterized by wheeled vehicles running on rails or tracks. They may provide long-distance intercity transit services as well as local daily commuter or intra-city trips. Rail transit systems may vary with respect to vehicle type, car count, operating speeds, right-of-way characteristics, and service schedule.
- ▶ **informal transit** a publicly available transit service that includes a fixed route service, fare structure, and regular operation. It does not consist of taxi, private shuttles or seasonal, on-call or on-demand transit.

Connection to Ongoing Performance

- ▶ LEED O+M LT prerequisite Transportation Performance: Locating a project in a dense area served by transit and diverse uses would have a significant positive impact on the transportation patterns of building occupants, which is a data set that project teams are required to collect in order to measure building performance under the performance-based LT prerequisite Transportation Performance.